

Levi Skye Morris

Technical executive · Engineering leader · Systems architect

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Technical executive and hands-on engineering leader with 11+ years building customer-facing products and infrastructure in financial technology, healthcare, e-commerce and distributed systems. Promoted from senior engineer to CTO; led a globally distributed organization through growth, banking and regulatory disruption, and an orderly wind-down, while staying close to architecture, reliability and the hardest technical problems.

CORE STRENGTHS

Leadership

Technical strategy, roadmapping, project and program management, hiring, coaching and distributed teams.

Systems

Payments and settlement, customer-facing applications, platform reliability, performance engineering, sensitive data and applied cryptography.

Operations

Regulated environments, incident response, crisis management, organizational change and responsible wind-downs.

EXPERIENCE

SpankChain

Remote · 2019–2026

Chief Technology Officer Jul 2020–Apr 2026

Acting Head of Engineering Dec 2019–Jul 2020

Senior Software Engineer Apr 2019–Dec 2019

- Promoted from senior engineer to CTO. Led an 8–10-person engineering organization across five countries and a 10-person contracted product team in Argentina, owning recruiting, hiring, coaching, performance management and workforce planning; together the teams built and operated three distinct products.
- Set technical direction across applications, backend services, payment workflows, data systems and blockchain infrastructure, and owned cloud operations on GCP: Kubernetes (GKE) with Helm, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, BigQuery and Pub/Sub.
- Partnered with product designers and commercial stakeholders to carry customer-facing features from concept to production. Without a dedicated project manager, built cross-product roadmaps with the CEO and CFO, broke them into epics and sprints and ran standups, planning and retros. Managed vendor contracts and SOWs for the contracted team. Built support and escalation processes from zero, with a rotating triage engineer and protected capacity for technical debt.
- Owned payment and settlement systems processing seven figures in transaction volume, including banking integrations, KYC/AML controls, GDPR/CCPA compliance and federal age- and identity-verification record-keeping (18 U.S.C. § 2257), along with security, reliability and incident response.
- Maintained Ethereum payment-channel infrastructure, working across signing, key management and Keccak hashing in Solidity, Vyper and JavaScript; used Python to parse complex smart-contract state from the Ethereum blockchain; stood up Keycloak as the identity and access layer for v2 of the payments platform.
- Sustained 99.9% platform uptime through the loss of banking partners, product de-platforming and shifting regulatory requirements; retained roughly 80% of the core team through a major product sunset and restructuring.
- Led the technical wind-down of the company: kept security and access controls intact through staff reductions, archived regulated data, advised leadership on the handoff of intellectual property and modeled the economics of recovering six-figure residual balances from retired payment-channel contracts against on-chain gas costs.

CampSpot

Denver, Colorado · 2017–2019

Senior Software Engineer Sep 2017–Feb 2019

- Architected and built a PCI DSS Level 1 payment gateway, including third-party processor integrations, transaction workflows, failure handling and AES-256 encryption of cardholder data.
- Built and scaled customer-facing reservation and payment systems with Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Dropwizard, Node.js, MySQL and React.

DocNetwork / CampDoc

Ann Arbor, Michigan · 2015–2017

Development Team Lead Aug 2015–Jun 2017

- Led a 3–5-person team building a HIPAA/FERPA-compliant electronic health record and registration platform for pediatric and educational organizations.
- Ran true XP, with mandatory driver/navigator pairing on sensitive features and mob programming for the worst outages; later carried the practice to CampSpot.

- Led engineering as monthly payment volume grew from six to seven figures, balancing delivery against privacy, security, data integrity and operational health.
- Resolved severe PostgreSQL performance bottlenecks through query-plan analysis, indexing, recursive CTEs and data-model changes.

SearchSpring

Colorado Springs, Colorado · 2014–2015

Integration Specialist Nov 2014–Aug 2015

- Built production e-commerce search integrations for Shopify, Magento, NetSuite and BigCommerce.
- Built pipelines that extracted client inventory and catalog data into S3 and indexed it into Elasticsearch, with custom relevance weighting for embedded SaaS search; diagnosed integration and production issues across the ELK stack.

Gelada Research Project

Simien Mountains, Ethiopia · 2012–2014

Field Site Manager Jun 2012–Jan 2014

- Ran personnel, logistics, safety, budgets and research data collection at a remote, high-altitude primate field station under tight operational, financial and physical constraints.
- Maintained and heavily extended the station's Palm Pilot data-collection software (NSBasic) with no prior programming experience and no internet access, including a custom text-file persistence layer the platform didn't natively support.

SELECTED WORK

Wildfire risk and edge photogrammetry

2026

Technical and business exploration

- Evaluated a wildfire-risk assessment service for real estate and insurance, and designed an edge-computing photogrammetry architecture combining UAV and on-foot capture to model structures, terrain, vegetation and Home Ignition Zones.
- Built a reporting pipeline that turns structured field observations into conservative, plain-language risk assessments, using constrained local inference checked by an independent auditing agent.

Computational ecology

2026

Clojure, Python and scientific computing

- Implemented configurable Ricker population models in Clojure with automated equilibrium and cycle detection, Lyapunov exponent estimation, bifurcation analysis and Vega-Lite visualizations.
- Building stochastic population and eco-evolutionary models in Python with NumPy and SciPy, with attention to vectorization, preallocated fixed-size arrays and amortized array growth for performance.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, Kotlin, Clojure, Python, SQL, Solidity, Vyper, R

Product and web: React, Angular, Vue, Node.js, NestJS, Express, Dropwizard, REST, GraphQL, HTML, CSS

Data: PostgreSQL (JSONB, HSTORE), MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana, S3-based data lakes

Infrastructure: AWS (S3, EC2, EKS, Lambda, RDS/Aurora, KMS, IAM, CloudFront); GCP (GKE, Cloud Run, BigQuery, Pub/Sub, Cloud SQL); Cloudflare (Workers, WAF, DDoS protection); Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Terraform, Linux, KVM/QEMU, Proxmox, Tailscale; networking (DNS, TLS, VPC design, load balancing)

Delivery and observability: Git, GitHub Actions, Buildkite, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Datadog, New Relic, Prometheus, Graylog

Process and project management: Kanban, Scrum, XP (pairing, mob programming), Jira, Confluence, GitHub Projects, Pivotal Tracker

AI and agentic systems: Claude, GPT, Gemini, Gemma, Qwen; Claude Code, Codex (CLI and IDE), OpenCode, Cline/Roo Code, LiteLLM, Ollama, MTPLEX; multi-model agentic workflows with cost- and privacy-aware routing between frontier APIs and self-hosted models; constrained generation with independent auditing agents

Security and cryptography: AES-256 and field-level encryption of cardholder data and SSNs, key management, digital signatures, salted hashing (bcrypt), Keccak/SHA-family hashing, in-house authentication systems, Keycloak

Risk and compliance: PCI DSS Level 1, HIPAA, FERPA, KYC/AML, GDPR/CCPA, 18 U.S.C. § 2257 record-keeping; security, privacy and incident response

EDUCATION AND RECOGNITION

University of Michigan · B.S., Evolutionary Anthropology · 2012

National Science Foundation · Graduate Research Fellowship Program, Honorable Mention · 2014